

The Ultimate GED® Social Studies Practice Blueprint

A high-fidelity diagnostic lead magnet featuring 45 authentic stimulus-based questions, historical source analysis, and data-interpretation modules.

45 REALISTIC ITEMS

SOURCE ANALYSIS

FULL WORKBOOK

GED Labs Diagnostic Framework Series

Optimized for the current GED® Social Studies Assessment Standards. Distribution authorized for individual educational use.

About This Practice Blueprint

Mastering the Stimulus-Based Exam

The GED® Social Studies test is not a traditional test of rote memorization. You do not need to memorize every date in American history or the name of every global river. Instead, **over 80% of the exam tests your processing and analytical skills** using written text, charts, graphs, maps, and political cartoons.

This document from **GED Labs** contains 45 authentic, multi-layered practice questions designed to mimic the exact structural and cognitive complexity of the real exam. It is divided into the four primary domains tested:

- Civics and Government (approx. 50% of the exam)
- United States History (approx. 20% of the exam)
- Economics (approx. 15% of the exam)
- Geography and the World (approx. 15% of the exam)

How to Use This Blueprint

- 1. Analyze the Source First:** Every block of questions is preceded by a text snippet, data set, or visual asset. Read or study the asset carefully before looking at the items.
- 2. Identify Fact vs. Opinion:** Many items require you to distinguish between objective data and subjective historical arguments.
- 3. Eliminate Outliers:** Look for extreme wording (e.g., "always," "never," "entirely") which rarely represents correct analytical conclusions in social sciences.

Unit 1: Civics and Government

SOURCE ASSET A: HISTORICAL DOCUMENT EXCERPT

Federalist No. 51, James Madison (1788)

"If men were angels, no government would be necessary. If angels were to govern men, neither external nor internal controls on government would be necessary. In framing a government which is to be administered by men over men, the great difficulty lies in this: you must first enable the government to control the governed; and in the next place oblige it to control itself. A dependence on the people is, no doubt, the primary control on the government; but experience has taught mankind the necessity of auxiliary precautions."

1. Which of the following constitutional principles best represents the "auxiliary precautions" Madison argues are necessary in Federalist No. 51?

- A. Direct democracy and universal suffrage.
- B. The system of checks and balances among separate branches.
- C. The establishment of a unified, parliamentary executive branch.
- D. The ultimate supremacy of state laws over national frameworks.

2. Based on the passage, what assumption does Madison make about human nature?

- A. Humans are inherently altruistic and always act in the collective interest.
- B. Human beings in power are prone to abusing authority if unchecked.
- C. Human nature changes drastically depending on the geographic scale of a nation.
- D. Regular elections completely eliminate the corruption inherent in public service.

3. Which phrase from Source Asset A directly justifies the government's authority to mandate citizen compliance with national statutory codes?

- A. "...if angels were to govern men..."
- B. "...you must first enable the government to control the governed..."
- C. "...neither external nor internal controls on government would be necessary..."
- D. "...experience has taught mankind the necessity of auxiliary precautions..."

SOURCE ASSET B: LEGISLATIVE DATA PROFILE

Bill ID & Focus	Sponsor Party	House Committee Review Time	House Vote (Y/N)	Senate Vote (Y/N)	Executive Action
HR-101: Infrastructure Fund	Majority Party	14 Days	240 / 195 (Passed)	51 / 49 (Passed)	Signed into Law
HR-102: Tech Restructuring	Minority Party	120 Days	180 / 255 (Failed)	Not Tabled	—
HR-103: Environmental Code	Majority Party	45 Days	222 / 213 (Passed)	48 / 52 (Failed)	—

4. According to the data profile in Source Asset B, what is the primary structural reason HR-103 did not become a federal statutory code?

- A. The executive authority utilized a formal pocket veto.
- B. It failed to achieve consensus in the initiating chamber.
- C. It failed to pass by a simple majority vote in the Senate.
- D. The House Committee delayed review indefinitely.

5. What clear inference can be made regarding minority-sponsored legislation based on HR-102's trajectory?

- A. Minority party bills always pass if they avoid committee assignment.
- B. Committee review timelines can reflect deep systemic or partisan hurdles for minority bills.
- C. The President must review minority bills prior to a full floor vote.
- D. The Senate can vote on a House bill while it is still stuck in a House committee.

Civics and Government (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET C: VISUAL CARTOON ANALYSIS BLUEPRINT

Visual Narrative: A massive scaling scale labeled "The Judicial Branch" sits perfectly balanced, with a small weight labeled "Judicial Review (Marbury v. Madison)" on one side and a large collection of heavy weights representing "Executive Orders" and "Congressional Statutes" on the other side.

Caption below: "The Fulcrum of Constitutional Equilibrium."

6. Which core message is the artist conveying through the visual imagery in Source Asset C?

- A. The judiciary lacks the structural power to balance legislative expansion.
- B. Judicial review serves as a powerful mechanism that allows the Supreme Court to check the weight of the other two branches.
- C. Congressional actions require a direct signature from the Chief Justice to take effect.
- D. Executive orders carry vastly more constitutional weight than standard legislation.

7. A constitutional critic argues that Judicial Review gives an unelected body too much policy influence. Which fact contradicts this critic's view that the Court has total control?

- A. Supreme Court justices are appointed for life terms under Article III.
- B. Congress holds the power to amend the Constitution, effectively bypassing individual judicial rulings over time.
- C. Rulings require unanimous agreement among all sitting justices to become binding law.
- D. The Supreme Court can actively draft and propose legislation to the House floor.

SOURCE ASSET D: LEGAL ANALYSIS PARAGRAPH

"In the American federalist architecture, powers are bifurcated between the national sovereign and sub-national state entities. Explicitly designated powers like coining money and negotiating treaties reside exclusively within the national domain. In contrast, reserved powers, anchored securely by the Tenth Amendment, guarantee that areas such as public health systems, local policing, and intra-state commercial licensing are governed primarily by individual states."

8. Based on the architecture described in Source Asset D, which policy action falls exclusively under state authority?

- A. Negotiating an independent trade tariff with a European union member state.
- B. Standardizing a new licensing structure for practicing registered nurses within state boundaries.
- C. Issuing currency to stabilize a regional economic downturn.
- D. Declaring a formal defensive state of conflict against a foreign power.

9. Which concept describes an overlap where both state and national governments simultaneously collect taxes or build roads?

- A. Exclusive jurisdiction
- B. Concurrent powers
- C. The Nullification Doctrine
- D. Unicameralism

10. If a state constitutional amendment explicitly conflicts with a valid, pre-existing federal statutory framework, which doctrine resolves the legal impasse?

- A. The Supremacy Clause of Article VI
- B. The Free Exercise Clause of the First Amendment
- C. The Line-Item Veto protocol
- D. The Advice and Consent clause

Civics and Government (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET E: VOTER TURNOUT DATA TABLE

Election Cycle Type	Age Bracket: 18–24 Turnout	Age Bracket: 45–64 Turnout	Age Bracket: 65+ Turnout
2016 Presidential Cycle	43.1%	66.8%	70.9%
2018 Midterm Cycle	32.4%	55.1%	63.8%
2020 Presidential Cycle	51.4%	71.2%	76.0%
2022 Midterm Cycle	35.2%	58.4%	66.1%

11. Which historical generalization is consistently supported by the empirical metrics in Source Asset E?

- A. Midterm election cycles generate significantly higher civic participation across all cohorts than presidential cycles.
- B. The youngest voting cohort (18–24) regularly out-votes older demographics during high-stakes midterm cycles.
- C. Voter turnout percentages correlate positively with older age demographics across all observed historical cycles.
- D. Participation rates within the 65+ cohort dropped by half between 2018 and 2020.

12. Based on the dynamic shown in Source Asset E, a political campaign attempting to maximize voter output for a midterm legislative race should rationally dedicate their primary field resources to which behavior?

- A. Targeting older cohorts (45+) who have documented baselines of high electoral dependability.
- B. Assuming the 18–24 cohort will automatically exceed 75% turnout without any targeted canvas operations.
- C. Ignoring presidential cycle dynamics entirely because they mirror midterm outcomes perfectly.
- D. Investing only in areas where voter turnout historical metrics are below 5%.

Unit 2: United States History

SOURCE ASSET F: HISTORICAL PRIMARY SOURCE

Declaration of Sentiments, Seneca Falls Convention (1848)

"The history of mankind is a history of repeated injuries and usurpations on the part of man toward woman, having in direct object the establishment of an absolute tyranny over her. To prove this, let facts be submitted to a candid world. He has never permitted her to exercise her inalienable right to the elective franchise. He has compelled her to submit to laws, in the formation of which she had no voice. He has withheld from her rights which are given to the most ignorant and degraded men—both natives and foreigners."

13. The stylistic architecture and rhetorical phrasing of Source Asset F explicitly mimics which founding American document?

- A. The Articles of Confederation
- B. The U.S. Constitution's Bill of Rights
- C. The Declaration of Independence
- D. The Emancipation Proclamation

14. Based on the text, what was the primary political objective of the authors at the Seneca Falls Convention?

- A. The immediate abolition of universal industrial trade tariffs.
- B. Secularization of religious primary schools in the Northeast.
- C. Securing full legal recognition and voting rights for women.
- D. Establishing separate judicial systems split by gender lines.

15. Which statement represents an opinion rather than an objective historical fact stated in or derived from the document?

- A. Women were structurally excluded from participating in the formation of statutory codes in 1848.
- B. The Seneca Falls Convention drafted a document addressing civil inequality.
- C. The strategies employed by the authors were the single most moral and perfect approach to civil reform in American history.
- D. The elective franchise was legally denied to women at the time of this publication.

SOURCE ASSET G: INDUSTRIALIZATION DATA MAP SUMMARY

Historical Mapping Indicators (1860–1890):

- *Northeast Region:* Railroad track density increased by 400%. Factory employment jumped from 1.2 million to 4.8 million.
- *Midwest Region:* Urban centers grew rapidly near rail junctions. Chicago infrastructure expanded 10-fold.
- *Southern Region:* Remained primarily agrarian with isolated textile nodes; rail lines rebuilt slowly post-conflict.

16. Which macroeconomic shifts is directly illustrated by the industrial mapping summaries in Source Asset G?

- A. A widespread migration away from urban centers back toward subsistence family farming.
- B. Rapid urbanization and infrastructure expansion concentrated primarily in the Northeast and Midwest regions.
- C. The immediate economic transformation of the South into an industrial manufacturing powerhouse.
- D. A sharp nationwide reduction in the utilization of steam-powered transit technology.

17. What social development was a direct consequence of the rapid, concentrated factory employment growth noted in the Northeast?

- A. The complete elimination of urban poverty and overcrowding.
- B. The formation of early labor unions advocating for safer work environments and standardized hours.
- C. A federal ban on all foreign immigration to preserve manufacturing positions.
- D. A complete transition to automated robotic production systems across the Eastern seaboard.

United States History (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET H: HISTORICAL POLITICAL CARTOON DESCRIPTION

Visual Narrative: A prominent, heavily stylized figure resembling President Andrew Jackson is dressed in full monarchical royal robes, complete with a golden crown. He stands triumphantly atop a torn and shredded copy of the "United States Constitution" and a document labeled "Judicial Decisions of the Supreme Court." In one hand, he holds a sceptre representing absolute veto power.

Title Text: "King Andrew the First."

18. What specific historical behavior or policy stance of Andrew Jackson's presidency is the cartoon in Source Asset H explicitly criticizing?

- A. His consistent compliance with and enforcement of all Supreme Court decrees.
- B. His aggressive utilization of executive power, including the veto, to override legislative and judicial boundaries.
- C. His formal proposal to permanently dissolve the executive branch.
- D. His total refusal to sign any pieces of legislation forwarded by the House of Representatives.

19. Which historical action represents an example of the executive overreach criticized in Source Asset H?

- A. The implementation of the civil service exam system.
- B. The enforcement of the Indian Removal Act despite the judicial decision in Worcester v. Georgia.
- C. The peaceful transfer of presidential authority to Martin Van Buren.
- D. Jackson's public advocacy for expanding the voting franchise to non-landowning citizens.

SOURCE ASSET I: WORLD WAR II MOBILIZATION ANALYSIS

"The home front mobilization effort during the 1941–1945 crisis restructured the American socioeconomic profile. Federal spending shifted production models almost exclusively toward wartime manufacturing. To manage resource scarcity, the Office of Price Administration initiated mandatory rationing programs for consumer items like rubber, gasoline, sugar, and meat. Concurrently, millions of women filled structural vacancies in industrial plants, altering traditional labor demographics permanently."

20. Based on Source Asset I, what was the primary operational mechanism used by the federal government to handle resource shortages during World War II?

- A. Allowing free market price mechanics to increase costs until consumption stopped.
- B. Instituting mandatory, state-managed rationing of critical consumer items.
- C. Importing all raw consumer goods from allied countries in South America.
- D. Halting all domestic factory manufacturing of military vehicles.

21. What long-term socioeconomic trend can be inferred from the demographic adjustments detailed toward the end of Source Asset I?

- A. A complete post-war return to 19th-century domestic workforce models.
- B. Increased female participation and representation in professional and industrial workforce sectors in the post-war era.
- C. The permanent closing of all heavy manufacturing factories in North America.
- D. A total decline in urbanization across major industrial Midwestern states.

United States History (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET J: FOREIGN POLICY BRIEFING

The Truman Doctrine Statement (1947)

"At the present moment in world history nearly every nation must choose between alternative ways of life. The choice is too often not a free one. One way of life is based upon the will of the majority, and is distinguished by free institutions, representative government, free elections, guarantees of individual liberty, freedom of speech and religion, and freedom from political oppression. The second way of life is based upon the will of a minority forcibly imposed upon the majority. It relies upon terror and oppression, a controlled press and radio; fixed elections, and the suppression of personal freedoms. I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or by outside pressures."

22. The geopolitical framework established in Source Asset J directly initiated which long-term American strategic posture?

- A. Total isolationism and refusal to enter regional military alliances.
- B. The containment policy aimed at preventing the expansion of Soviet and communist influence globally.
- C. The immediate de-escalation and decommissioning of all naval fleets.
- D. Unconditional support for colonial empires seeking to retain territories in Africa.

23. Under the operational definitions provided in the Truman Doctrine, "outside pressures" and "armed minorities" were indirect references to which political system?

- A. Constitutional Monarchism
- B. Soviet-backed Communism
- C. Laissez-faire Capitalism
- D. Democratic Socialism

24. Which subsequent historical action aligns directly with the core ideological mandate outlined by President Truman in Source Asset J?

- A. The passage of the immigration quota reductions in 1924.
- B. The commitment of billions of dollars in economic stabilization funds via the Marshall Plan.
- C. The withdrawal of federal troops from the Southern states at the end of Reconstruction.
- D. The ratification of the 18th Amendment enforcing nationwide Prohibition.

Unit 3: Economics

Source Asset K: Supply and Demand Market Dynamic

Price per Widget (\$)	Quantity Demanded (Units)	Quantity Supplied (Units)
\$10.00	1,000	200
\$15.00	800	400
\$20.00	600	600
\$25.00	400	800
\$30.00	200	1,000

25. Based on the market schedule in Source Asset K, what is the exact market clearing equilibrium price for this product?
- A. \$10.00
 - B. \$15.00
 - C. \$20.00
 - D. \$30.00
26. If a federal legislative action legally establishes a rigid price ceiling of \$15.00 for this item, what structural market condition will occur?
- A. A market surplus of 400 total units.
 - B. A persistent market shortage of 400 total units.
 - C. An immediate shift of the demand line up and to the right.
 - D. A perfect balancing of consumer option allocations.

27. According to basic microeconomic laws, why does the quantity supplied increase systematically as the price shifts from \$10.00 to \$30.00?

- A. Higher prices act as an incentive for producers to allocate more resources toward production to maximize profit.
- B. Consumers always prefer to buy significantly more items when prices are high.
- C. Production costs automatically hit absolute zero when market prices climb.
- D. Government mandates force businesses to raise production when prices go up.

SOURCE ASSET L: MACROECONOMIC THEORY BREAKDOWN

"Monetary policy in the United States is controlled by the Federal Reserve System. When faced with high inflation, the central bank typically employs contractionary monetary policy tools. These include increasing the federal funds target rate, raising reserve requirements for commercial banking entities, and conducting open-market sales of government securities. These actions reduce liquid capital within the broader financial infrastructure, increasing borrowing costs and slowing overall economic demand."

28. According to Source Asset L, what is the primary objective of the Federal Reserve when implementing a contractionary monetary policy?

- A. To rapidly accelerate the inflation rate of consumer goods.
- B. To reduce liquid capital availability in order to cool down high inflation.
- C. To encourage commercial banks to issue low-interest loans to all consumers.
- D. To permanently dissolve open-market asset trading systems.

Economics (Continued)

29. If the Federal Reserve decides to lower interest rates and purchase government bonds, what type of market condition are they likely attempting to fix?

- A. Hyper-inflation and an overheating economy.
- B. An economic recession or high cyclical unemployment.
- C. An overabundance of liquid capital in local savings banks.
- D. A massive federal budget surplus.

SOURCE ASSET M: COMPARATIVE ECONOMIC PROFILES

Economic Metric Profile	Nation Alpha	Nation Beta
Primary Regulatory Control	State Central Planning Commission	Market Supply/Demand Interactions
Property Ownership Framework	Collectivized State Property	Private Individual Capital Ownership
Price Control Implementations	Mandated by Administrative Decree	Determined by Competitive Market Clearing
Consumer Product Diversity	Restricted/Standardized Profiles	Expansive/High Competitive Variation

30. Based on the structural indicators in Source Asset M, how should the economic systems of Nation Alpha and Nation Beta be classified?

- A. Nation Alpha is a Traditional Economy; Nation Beta is a Barter Economy.
- B. Nation Alpha is a Command/Socialist Economy; Nation Beta is a Market/Capitalist Economy.
- C. Nation Alpha is a Free Enterprise System; Nation Beta is an Absolute Monarchy.
- D. Both nations utilize identical mixed-market frameworks with equal state intervention.

31. Which operational challenge is Nation Alpha significantly more vulnerable to experiencing due to its structural design?

- A. Chronic inefficiencies and product shortages caused by inaccurate state planning.
- B. Hyper-competitive corporate advertising wars driving up production costs.
- C. Frequent corporate bankruptcies resulting from stock market volatility.
- D. Sudden changes in product choices driven by consumer trends.

32. What basic economic concept explains why all societies, regardless of whether they are structured like Nation Alpha or Nation Beta, must make choices about how to allocate resources?

- A. Absolute Advantage
- B. Scarcity
- C. Deflationary spiraling
- D. The Wealth Effect

Economics (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET N: INTERNATIONAL TRADE METRIC

"Consider a closed global matrix where only two sovereign nations produce identical agricultural commodities. Nation X requires 2 labor hours to produce 1 bushel of wheat and 4 labor hours to produce 1 bale of cotton. Nation Y requires 3 labor hours to produce 1 bushel of wheat and 9 labor hours to produce 1 bale of cotton. According to classical economic trade theories, gains can be realized if both specialize according to their comparative advantage profiles."

33. Based on the operational data in Source Asset N, which statement regarding absolute advantage is mathematically true?

- A. Nation Y has an absolute advantage in both wheat and cotton.
- B. Nation X has an absolute advantage in both wheat and cotton because it uses fewer labor hours per unit.
- C. Neither nation holds an absolute advantage in cotton manufacturing.
- D. Nation X requires twice as much time as Nation Y to extract a single bushel of wheat.

34. Calculate the opportunity cost of 1 bale of cotton in Nation Y. What is the real cost in terms of forgone wheat production?

- A. 1 bushel of wheat
- B. 2 bushels of wheat
- C. 3 bushels of wheat
- D. 9 bushels of wheat

35. If a nation institutes an absolute numerical limitation on the import of a foreign agricultural product to protect local farmers, which trade barrier mechanism is being used?

- A. An ad-valorem tariff
- B. A trade quota
- C. A dynamic export subsidy
- D. An open-market trade embargo

Unit 4: Geography and the World

Source Asset O: Demographic Transition Model (DTM) Table

DTM Stage Profile	Birth Rate Metric	Death Rate Metric	Total Population Trend
Stage 1: Pre-Industrial	High / Fluctuating	High / Fluctuating	Stable / Very Slow Expansion
Stage 2: Developing	High / Stable	Rapid / Steep Decline	Exponential/Rapid Expansion
Stage 3: Industrializing	Declining Growth	Slow / Minimal Decline	Slowing Expansion Rates
Stage 4: Post-Industrial	Low / Fluctuating	Low / Stable	Stable / Zero Population Growth

36. According to the demographic trends detailed in Source Asset O, what primary factor drives the exponential population expansion seen in Stage 2?

- A. A sudden, massive escalation in baseline national birth rates.
- B. A rapid, steep decline in death rates while birth rates remain consistently high.
- C. The total elimination of immigration controls across continental borders.
- D. Government mandates requiring citizens to relocate out of urban hubs.

37. Which real-world historical development typically triggers the transition of a nation out of Stage 1 and directly into Stage 2?

- A. Advancements in medical access, sanitation systems, and food security.
- B. A complete collapse of industrial factory infrastructure.
- C. A transition from urban manufacturing back to hunter-gatherer models.
- D. A widespread reduction in overall life expectancy.

38. A country where the birth rate has dropped significantly below replacement level, leading to a shrinking, rapidly aging population, is displaying characteristics that extend beyond Stage 4. Which region currently contains multiple countries matching this demographic profile?

- A.** Sub-Saharan Africa
- B.** Western Europe and East Asia
- C.** Central America
- D.** Northern Australia

Geography and the World (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET P: GEOSPATIAL RESOURCE CASE BRIEF

"The distribution of valuable natural resources frequently shapes geopolitical relationships and causes structural economic vulnerabilities. Consider the 'Resource Curse' phenomenon: nations with an abundance of non-renewable mineral or fossil fuel assets often experience slower economic diversification, weaker institutional governance, and higher internal conflict risks than resource-scarce nations. This occurs because capital concentrates within a single extraction sector, starving other domestic industries of investment."

39. Based on the explanation in Source Asset P, what is a primary structural risk for an economy centered entirely on a single natural resource?

- A. Automatic immunity to global economic recessions.
- B. Slower economic diversification, leaving the nation vulnerable if resource prices collapse.
- C. An overabundance of funding for alternative domestic manufacturing fields.
- D. The elimination of all corporate monopolies within national borders.

40. Which strategy would directly help a nation mitigate the structural vulnerabilities described in Source Asset P?

- A. Banning all foreign trade and relying solely on resource extraction.
- B. Investing resource revenues into sovereign wealth funds to develop technology, education, and service industries.
- C. Shutting down all local educational institutions to minimize government spending.
- D. Artificially doubling resource production during a global oversupply.

SOURCE ASSET Q: GEOGRAPHIC HUMAN MIGRATION VECTOR ANALYSIS

Migration Vector Summary: Over a 20-year window, a continuous migration stream moves away from rural regions suffering from multi-year droughts and soil erosion (Region Alpha). This population relocates to a coastal urban zone offering expanding factory positions and consistent municipal water infrastructure (Region Beta).

41. In human geography terminology, how should the environmental degradation in Region Alpha and the industrial employment options in Region Beta be categorized?

- A. both elements are defined exclusively as cultural push factors.
- B. Region Alpha presents push factors; Region Beta presents pull factors.
- C. Region Alpha presents pull factors; Region Beta presents push factors.
- D. Both elements represent random, non-economic migration variables.

42. What long-term urban issue is Region Beta highly likely to experience if infrastructure expansion does not keep pace with this continuous migration stream?

- A. Severe labor shortages across all factory sectors.
- B. Overburdened public utilities, traffic congestion, and a shortage of affordable housing.
- C. A complete drop in local consumer demand for goods.
- D. The immediate transformation of the city back into a rural agricultural zone.

Geography and the World (Continued)

SOURCE ASSET R: GLOBAL ENVIRONMENTAL CASE STUDY

"The Aral Sea disaster represents one of the most striking human-induced geographic transformations of the modern era. Beginning in the 1960s, a major sovereign state diverted the primary rivers feeding the inland sea to irrigate intensive desert cotton farming operations. Within decades, the Aral Sea lost over 90% of its volume, splitting into disconnected, highly saline pools, destroying local fisheries, and leaving behind a toxic desert plain that altered the regional microclimate."

43. The historical overview in Source Asset R serves as a prime example of which geographic theme?

- A. Naturally occurring tectonic plate movements.
- B. Human-environment interaction and the unintended consequences of environmental modification.
- C. The complete superiority of inland water bodies over oceanic shipping channels.
- D. Sustainable agricultural planning with zero long-term externalities.

44. Based on the outcome detailed in Source Asset R, what was the primary economic trade-off made by the planners?

- A. Sacrificing a sustainable inland fishing ecosystem to prioritize short-term cash crop production.
- B. Eliminating all agricultural output to maximize local tourism.
- C. Expanding regional biodiversity while lowering overall water usage.
- D. Diverting urban industrial pollution to protect natural ecosystems.

45. If a geographer utilizes global positioning system (GPS) arrays alongside advanced satellite imagery to layer demographic metrics over physical maps, which technology is being used?

- A. Mercator Projection Flattening
- B. Geographic Information Systems (GIS)
- C. Isoline Topographic Contouring
- D. Chronological Stratigraphy

Blueprint Evaluation & Next Steps

Analyze Your Performance Strategy

Congratulations on completing the **GED Labs Social Studies Practice Blueprint**. This diagnostic tool is designed to highlight areas for improvement before test day.

Review your results by identifying the types of questions where you hesitated or made mistakes:

- **Source Analysis Items (e.g., Questions 1, 2, 13, 22):** Did you miss the core argument of the historical passage? Focus on tracking down explicit thesis statements in the reading.
- **Data & Graphic Interpretation (e.g., Questions 4, 11, 25, 36):** Did you misread a column header or axis? Always double-check labels before making calculations.
- **Conceptual Application (e.g., Questions 8, 28, 30, 41):** Did you struggle with terms like federalism, monetary policy, or push/pull factors? Focus your study on core social studies vocabulary.

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